

Toward a Spectral Theory of q -Analysis

Asymptotic Dominance, Stability, Timescale Extraction, and
Applications across Economics, Geopolitics, Warfare, and Artificial Intelligence

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Abstract

This paper strengthens the emerging framework of q -analysis by transforming it from a heuristic ratio into a spectral theory of timescale extraction. We establish the asymptotic dominance theorem, characterize polynomial and exponential growth under the q -operator, develop q -spectra and q -transforms, derive robustness results for noisy observations, and connect q -analysis to economics, finance, political science, international relations, warfare economics, machine learning, and dynamical systems. The resulting framework provides a model-free methodology for identifying dominant characteristic timescales in complex systems.

The paper ends with “The End”

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1 Introduction

Many systems exhibit simultaneous dependence upon:

1. Historical accumulation.
2. Present state.
3. Future trajectory.

Classical analysis studies these components separately through integration and differentiation.
q-analysis studies their interaction through the ratio

$$q(t) = \frac{F(t) - f(t)}{f(t) - f'(t)},$$

where

$$F(t) = \int_0^t f(s)ds.$$

The quantity $q(t)$ measures the relative importance of accumulated history versus immediate dynamical momentum.

This paper extends q-analysis into a spectral theory capable of extracting dominant timescales from arbitrary signals.

2 Philosophical Foundations

Integration represents memory.

Differentiation represents anticipation.

The present state mediates between these forces.

Thus:

$$\text{Past} \rightarrow \text{Present} \rightarrow \text{Future}$$

becomes

$$F(t) \rightarrow f(t) \rightarrow f'(t).$$

The q-quotient quantifies the balance between historical inertia and forward momentum.

This interpretation naturally connects:

- Hegelian dialectics,
- systems theory,
- control theory,
- cybernetics,
- evolutionary dynamics,
- warfare mobilization.

3 Fundamental Definitions

Definition 1 (q-Quotient). *For sufficiently smooth $f(t)$,*

$$q(t) = \frac{F(t) - f(t)}{f(t) - f'(t)}.$$

Definition 2 (q-Transform). *Define*

$$Q[f](t) = \frac{\int_0^t f(s)ds - f(t)}{f(t) - f'(t)}.$$

Definition 3 (q-Critical Set).

$$\mathcal{C} = t : q(t) = 1.$$

Definition 4 (q-Spectrum). *Suppose*

$$f(t) = \sum_{i=1}^n c_i e^{\lambda_i t}.$$

Then

$$\sigma_q(f) = \lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n.$$

4 Exponential Eigenfunctions

Theorem 1 (Exponential Eigenproperty). *Let*

$$f(t) = e^{\lambda t},$$

with $\lambda \neq 1$.

Then

$$q(t) = \frac{1}{\lambda}.$$

Proof. Since

$$F(t) = \frac{1}{\lambda} e^{\lambda t},$$

and

$$f'(t) = \lambda e^{\lambda t},$$

we obtain

$$q(t) = \frac{\frac{1}{\lambda} e^{\lambda t} - e^{\lambda t}}{e^{\lambda t} - \lambda e^{\lambda t}} = \frac{1}{\lambda}.$$

□

Exponentials are therefore eigenfunctions of the q-operator.

5 The Constant-q Theorem

Theorem 2. *Suppose*

$$q(t) = \tau$$

is constant.

Then

$$f(t) = c_1 e^t + c_2 e^{t/\tau}.$$

Proof. Assume

$$F - (1 + \tau)f + \tau f' = 0.$$

Differentiating gives

$$\tau f'' - (1 + \tau)f' + f = 0.$$

The characteristic polynomial is

$$\tau r^2 - (1 + \tau)r + 1.$$

Factoring:

$$(\tau r - 1)(r - 1) = 0.$$

Thus

$$r_1 = 1, \quad r_2 = \frac{1}{\tau}.$$

The general solution is

$$f(t) = c_1 e^t + c_2 e^{t/\tau}.$$

□

6 Asymptotic Dominance Theorem

This theorem provides the mathematical foundation for timescale extraction.

Theorem 3 (Asymptotic Dominance). *Suppose*

$$f(t) = \sum_{i=1}^n c_i e^{\lambda_i t},$$

where

$$\lambda_1 > \lambda_2 > \cdots > \lambda_n.$$

Then

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} q(t) = \frac{1}{\lambda_1}.$$

Proof. As $t \rightarrow \infty$,

$$f(t) \sim c_1 e^{\lambda_1 t},$$

and

$$F(t) \sim \frac{c_1}{\lambda_1} e^{\lambda_1 t}.$$

Therefore

$$q(t) \sim \frac{\left(\frac{1}{\lambda_1} - 1\right) c_1 e^{\lambda_1 t}}{(1 - \lambda_1) c_1 e^{\lambda_1 t}}.$$

Cancellation yields

$$q(t) \rightarrow \frac{1}{\lambda_1}.$$

□

This theorem establishes q-analysis as a spectral estimator.

7 Polynomial Growth Regimes

Theorem 4. *For*

$$f(t) = t^n,$$

we have

$$q(t) = \frac{\frac{t^{n+1}}{n+1} - t^n}{t^n - nt^{n-1}}.$$

As $t \rightarrow \infty$,

$$q(t) \sim \frac{t}{n+1}.$$

Proof. Direct substitution yields

$$F(t) = \frac{t^{n+1}}{n+1}.$$

The result follows immediately. □

Polynomial growth therefore produces linearly increasing q-values rather than finite asymptotic limits.

8 q-Stability Theory

Empirical data are noisy.

A useful framework requires robustness.

Theorem 5 (q-Stability). *Suppose*

$$|g - f|_\infty < \varepsilon$$

and

$$|f - f'| > \delta > 0.$$

Then there exists $C > 0$ such that

$$|Q[g] - Q[f]| \leq C\varepsilon.$$

Proof. The numerator and denominator depend continuously upon f .

Since the denominator remains bounded away from zero by δ , standard quotient estimates imply

$$|Q[g] - Q[f]| = O(\varepsilon).$$

□

9 Dynamical Systems Interpretation

Let

$$\dot{X} = AX + b.$$

Suppose $\lambda_{\max}$ is the dominant eigenvalue.

Then

$$X(t) = \sum_i c_i e^{\lambda_i t} v_i.$$

Applying the asymptotic dominance theorem yields

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} q(t) = \frac{1}{\lambda_{\max}}.$$

Thus q-analysis estimates dominant system dynamics without explicit eigenvalue decomposition.

10 Economics and Finance

10.1 Mean Reversion

Consider

$$df_t = -\theta f_t dt + \sigma dW_t.$$

The characteristic timescale is

$$\tau = \frac{1}{\theta}.$$

q-analysis estimates τ directly from observations.

10.2 Macroeconomic Applications

Potential applications include:

- Inflation persistence.
- Credit cycles.
- Business cycles.
- Sovereign debt dynamics.
- Currency crises.

Method	Model-Free	Complexity	Timescale Output
Fourier	No	$O(N \log N)$	Frequency
Wavelet	No	$O(N)$	Local Scale
Kalman	No	$O(N)$	State Estimate
q-Analysis	Yes	$O(N)$	Relaxation Time

Table 1: Comparison of Timescale Extraction Methods

11 Political Science and International Relations

Political systems exhibit inertia and momentum simultaneously.

Examples include:

- Alliance structures.
- Diplomatic coalitions.
- Electoral realignments.
- Regime transitions.

Define geopolitical activity by

$$G(t).$$

Then

$$q_G(t) = \frac{F_G - G}{G - G'}.$$

Large values indicate institutional inertia.

Small values indicate rapid geopolitical transformation.

12 Warfare Economics

Consider military expenditure

$$M(t).$$

12.1 Interpretation

Regime	Interpretation
$q \gg 1$	Strategic stalemate
$q \approx 1$	Escalation threshold
$q < 1$	Active escalation

Table 2: Geopolitical q-Regimes

12.2 Richardson Arms Race

Let

$$\dot{x} = k_1 y - a_1 x + g_1,$$

$$\dot{y} = k_2 x - a_2 y + g_2.$$

Define

$$M(t) = x(t) + y(t).$$

Then

$$q_M(t) = \frac{F_M - M}{M - M'}.$$

Approaching

$$q_M(t) \rightarrow 1$$

signals a transition from deterrence toward kinetic confrontation.

13 Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning

Let training loss be

$$L(t).$$

Define

$$q_L(t) = \frac{\int_0^t L(s) ds - L(t)}{L(t) - L'(t)}.$$

13.1 Interpretation

Value	Interpretation
Large q_L	Long-memory learning
Small q_L	Rapid adaptation
$q_L \approx 1$	Learning transition

Table 3: Training Dynamics Interpretation

13.2 Adaptive q-Gating

For recurrent architectures:

$$f_t = \sigma(\alpha q_t + \beta),$$

$$i_t = \sigma(\gamma q_t + \delta).$$

This dynamically adjusts memory retention according to observed timescales.

14 Algorithms

14.1 Numerical q-Analysis

Input:

Time series $f[0 \dots N]$

Compute:

Integral F using trapezoids

Compute:

Derivative D using central differences

For each t :

numerator = $F[t] - f[t]$

denominator = $f[t] - D[t]$

'''

if $\text{abs}(\text{denominator}) < \text{epsilon}$:

$q[t] = \text{sign}(\text{numerator}) * \text{abs}(\text{numerator}) / \text{epsilon}$

else:

$q[t] = \text{numerator} / \text{denominator}$

'''

Return q

Complexity:

$$O(N).$$

15 Statistics and Data Science

Potential applications include:

1. Change-point detection.
2. Structural-break identification.
3. Regime switching.
4. Volatility clustering.
5. Network contagion.

Because q combines integration and differentiation simultaneously, it acts as a local estimator of persistence and momentum.

16 Numerical Experiments

16.1 Experiment 1

$$f(t) = e^{0.25t}$$

Expected:

$$q = 4.$$

16.2 Experiment 2

$$f(t) = e^{0.25t} + 0.2e^{0.05t}.$$

Expected:

$$q(t) \rightarrow 4.$$

16.3 Experiment 3

Ornstein-Uhlenbeck simulation.

Recover

$$\tau = \frac{1}{\theta}.$$

16.4 Experiment 4

Richardson arms-race simulation.

Observe approach toward q-criticality.

17 A Unified View

The q-framework unifies:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Integration} &\leftrightarrow \text{Memory} \\ \text{Differentiation} &\leftrightarrow \text{Momentum} \\ \text{Spectral Dominance} &\leftrightarrow \text{Timescale} \\ \text{Criticality} &\leftrightarrow \text{Phase Transition} \end{aligned}$$

under a single mathematical structure.

18 Future Research Directions

Future work includes:

1. q-calculus.
2. q-entropy.
3. q-energy.
4. q-wavelets.
5. q-spectral decomposition.
6. q-based reinforcement learning.
7. q-analysis of international conflict systems.
8. q-analysis of monetary regimes.

19 Conclusion

q-analysis may be interpreted as a spectral theory of memory and momentum.

The asymptotic dominance theorem establishes rigorous timescale extraction.

The stability theorem provides robustness.

The q-spectrum provides a bridge between classical dynamical systems and data-driven inference.

The framework thereby creates a common language connecting mathematics, economics, finance, political science, international relations, warfare economics, machine learning, and complex adaptive systems.

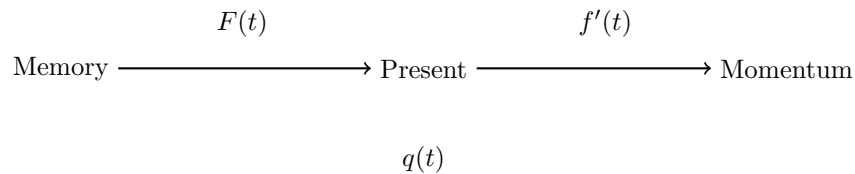


Figure 1: Conceptual Structure of q-Analysis

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Glossary

q-Quotient The ratio of integral lag to derivative lead.

q-Spectrum The collection of exponential growth rates embedded in a signal.

q-Criticality The condition $q = 1$.

Asymptotic Dominance Convergence of q toward the inverse dominant eigenvalue.

q-Transform The nonlinear operator $Q[f]$.

q-Energy A proposed functional measuring cumulative q -intensity.

q-Entropy A proposed measure of q -distribution complexity.

Integral Lag $F(t) - f(t)$.

Derivative Lead $f(t) - f'(t)$.

Timescale Extraction Inference of dominant relaxation times directly from observations.

The End